

BOOK

Blood, Sweat and Pixels

★★★★☆ | Blood, Sweat and Pixels is written by Kotaku news editor Jason Schreier. The name might seem familiar to those of you who scour the interwebs for gaming related news, because his is one that pops up often.

Blood, Sweat and Pixels is an entire book based on what he learned during his investigations into the creation of ten games; ten games, ten chapters, each dedicated to a game.

Titles include huge AAA projects like Uncharted 4, The Witcher 3, and Dragon Age: Inquisition. Then there are indie superhits like Stardew Valley, Pillars of Eternity and Shovel Knight. There's a chapter dedicated to Destiny, and then the book ends with a chapter for Star Wars 1313, a much awaited game that never saw the light of launch day.

The book highlights the brutality that is game development. The very start of the book mentions how it's a miracle that most games release at all! Don't expect a fun or exciting read, but expect an interesting one that has you gripped nonetheless.

The book gives you insight on what truly goes into making a game. It goes into detail how things can go wrong during any stage of a game's development, be it issues with the games' engines or even just a lack of synergy between team members. A must read for gamers, which gives them a behind-the-scenes perspective.



MOVIE

Blade Runner 2049

★★★★☆ | The thing about cult classics is that they never make it large in the box office but stay relevant for decades. It happened with the first Blade Runner movie and we might just see history repeating itself with the new one. The sequel follows where the original had left but doesn't really clarify all the events.

There's a chance that you might have seen the original but if you haven't, it is important that you do so. Look for the final cut of Blade Runner that was released in 2007. Every scene in the movie, including the original, has important scenes and if you get distracted, you might miss something. But don't expect your queries from the original to be answered in the sequel. In fact, you'll end up with more doubts.

It's highly recommended that you watch the movie at an IMAX screen, since it's a beautiful experience with incredible background scoring and wonderful visuals of the dystopian world. Also, there are three clips you must watch, which bridge the two movies to give you a clue on what's going on. Being fans of sci-fi that keeps you talking for decades, we didn't check our watches despite the 163 minute run.



UP AND COMING

MOVIE

Justice League

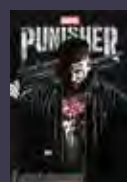


After the success Wonder Woman saw, there's a lot of hype over the new Justice League movie. A lot of us here at the labs liked Batman v Superman too, so we're excited about this one. Let's just hope it doesn't let anyone down.

Release date: November 17

TV SHOW

The Punisher



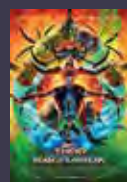
The Punisher is coming. After the recent bout of Marvel's TV shows flopped big time (we're looking

at you Defenders), people are actually looking forward to this one. So are we. Once again, fingers crossed.

Release date: November 17

MOVIE

Thor: Ragnarok



The third Thor movie and the seventeenth movie in the entire MCU, Thor: Ragnarok's trailer gave it a very Guardians of the Galaxy vibe. Can Thor save Asgard from Hela? We'll find out soon.

Release date: November 3